2.5. Strings

It’s possible to write CoffeeScript programs using only expressions containing the literal values already shown, but other language features and libraries provide convenient ways to do common tasks. Every program deals with text at some point, so it’s useful to have some more string tools in your string toolbox. This section demonstrates some of the built-in string methods from JavaScript that are useful in CoffeeScript. This section also introduces string interpolation, which provides an elegant way to use variables inside strings.

2.5.1. Methods

CoffeeScript strings have all of the same built-in methods as JavaScript strings. Here are some of the most useful string methods.

Searching

Use the `search` method on a string to find another string within:

```
'haystack'.search 'needle'
# -1

'haystack'.search 'hay'
# 0

'haystack'.search 'stack'
# 3
```

The number returned by `search` is the index in the string at which the match starts. If it returns `-1`, then no match was found. If it returns `0`, the match starts at the beginning of the string.

Suppose you have all of the coffee drinks you serve containing milk in a string:

```
'latte,mocha,cappuccino,flat white,eiskaffee'
```

How do you write a new `hasMilk` function to use instead of a `switch`?